

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Seasoned Graphic Designer and Production Lead with over 20 years of experience in print media, layout design, and end-to-end newspaper production. Highly proficient in Adobe InDesign, Photoshop, and Illustrator, with a sharp eye for detail and a strong grasp of visual hierarchy and typographic balance. Adept at managing tight weekly deadlines, collaborating across departments, and supporting editorial teams with copy editing and content organization. Passionate about clear communication and clean, effective design.

SKILLS

DESIGN & TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

- Adobe InDesign (advanced)
- Adobe Photoshop (proficient)
- Adobe Illustrator (intermediate)
- Page Layout & Composition
- Typographic Hierarchy & Style Emulation
- Print Production & Prepress
- Color Theory
- WordPress & Wix Website Management
- Basic HTML & CSS
- Google Workspace: Docs, Sheets (proficient)

SOFT SKILLS & COLLABORATION

- Style Matching & Brand Consistency
- Editorial Support: Copy Editing & Proofreading
- Content Organization
- Cross-Team Collaboration
- Deadline Management in Fast-Paced Environments
- Strong Web Literacy & Resourceful Problem-Solving

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graphic Designer / Production Lead

Village News, Inc. | 2004–Present

- Lead end-to-end production of weekly Valley News and Anza Valley Outlook (14,000 circulation), improving layout efficiency and ensuring on-time press delivery.
- Edit and organize editorial content, including incoming press releases and staff submissions, perform copy editing, and coordinate images and story placements.
- Maintain weekly editorial workflow: compile editorial run lists, assign story positions, and finalize press-ready PDFs for out-of-house printer.
- Designed advertisements and editorial layouts for Village News, Valley News, and Anza Valley Outlook.
- Contributed to Lifestyle Magazine (2008-2011) and the Greater Fallbrook Area Sourcebook (2005-2012) through advertisement design, layout, and editorial collaboration.
- Shifted to a hybrid remote role in 2012, focusing on Valley News production.
- Upload weekly editorial content to a WordPress website (myvalleynews.com).

Karina Young

GRAPHIC DESIGNER

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FREELANCE EXPERIENCE

Graphic Designer

Skyrocket Education Services | skyrocket-ed.com | 2025–Present

- Edit and update Adobe InDesign documents based on revision requests from internal teams.
- Implement content corrections, layout adjustments, and formatting updates across educational materials.
- Maintain document consistency with established templates, styles, and branding guidelines.

Web & Content Designer

Birthline of San Diego | birthlineofsandiego.org | 2024–Present

- Maintain and update nonprofit website using WordPress tools and templates.
- Customize layouts and elements with HTML and CSS to enhance user experience and branding.
- Support digital content updates and ensure site remains current and accessible.

Graphic Designer

Sun Hero Magazine | sunheromagazine.com | 2023–Present

- Design page layouts and advertisements for niche publication focused on Black nerd culture.
- Collaborate directly with the creator on content decisions, research, and visual storytelling.
- Conduct light copy editing and ensure cohesive visual presentation across all issues.

Graphic Designer

PurEarth2o Inc. | purearth2o.com | 2012–Present

- Design marketing collateral including brochures, business cards, and product labels.
- Built and launched the company's website using Wix.
- Provide ongoing design support for print and digital projects as needed.

Graphic Designer

University of California, Irvine – Athletics Department | 2015–2016 and 2024

- Designed print materials including brochures, game programs, event banners, credentials, and promotional mailers.
- Applied consistent brand styling using official UC Irvine logos, custom fonts, and institutional color palettes.
- Delivered projects for both internal and public-facing athletic events with quick turnaround and high accuracy.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Art/Graphic Design

California State University, San Bernardino

2000–2003

Web Design Essentials Coursework

Santa Monica College

2016–2018

AWARDS

2011 Society of Professional Journalists Award, San Diego Pro Chapter

- First Place, Magazines: Layout & Design (Story or Series), "1600 Degrees of Perfection at the Oak Room" published in Village Lifestyle Magazine.
- Second Place, Magazines: Layout & Design (Story or Series), "Bugs in your Plants?" published in Village Lifestyle Magazine.

2005 Society of Professional Journalists Award, San Diego Pro Chapter

- Third Place, Features Category, "Fallbrook Garden Club: 75 Years Strong" written by Sarah Bates, graphic design by Karina Young, published in the Village News.